

Questions - Part VI - Job Questions

A Quick-Reference Guide

Basic Job Questions

"Where do you work?"
 "What do you do?"
 "Who do you work for?"

(Where does she work?)
 (What does she do?)
 (Who does he work for?)

More Job Questions

"What company do you work for?"
 "What are you?"
 "What is your job?"
 "What line of work are you in?"
 "What do you do for a living?"
 "For whom do you work?"
 "Who employs you?"
 "Who is your employer?"
 "Where are you working?"
 "Where are you employed?"
 "What kind of work do you do?"
 "What field are you in?"
 "What area are you in?"
 "What profession are you in?"
 "What is your profession?"
 "What is your occupation?"
 "What is your area?"
 "What is your field?"
 "What work do you do?"

(What company does she work for?)
 (What is she?)
 (What is her job?)
 (What line of work is she in?)
 (What does she do for a living?)
 (For whom does she work?)
 (Who employs her?)
 (Who is his employer?)
 (Where is he working?)
 (Where is she employed?)
 (What kind of work does she do?)
 (What field is she in?)
 (What are is he in?)
 (What profession is she in?)
 (What is her profession?)
 (What is his occupation?)
 (What's her area?)
 (What's her field?)
 (What work does he do?)

Notes:

1. The answer to all of the above is generally the same.

I work for (company) in the (department). I work in/with (job focus).

2. To get more information about departments, job titles, etc., people often will keep asking more questions.

These are examples of normal forms.

A: Where do you work?	A: What are you?	A: So, what do you do?
B: I work for Toyota.	B: I'm an engineer for Toyota.	B: I work for Toyota.
A: What are you?	A: What do you do?	A: Really. What are you?
B: I'm an engineer?	B: I design doors.	B: I'm an engineer.
A: What do you do?		A: What's your area.
B: I design doors.		B: I work with doors

3. You can use "What," "Who," or "Where" to be begin this same question.
 4. All of the above questions are relatively common.
 5. In English, companies and stores are often referred to as people are, using words such as "Who," "They," and "We."
 6. When you are giving a short or abbreviated answer, the form of the answer must match the form of the question question.

Q: What is he?	Q: What does he do?	Q: What does he do?	Q: What does he do?
A: (He is) A consultant?	A: He is a consultant.	A: A consultant. (This would mean: "He does a consultant." which has no standard English meaning.)	A: Consulting

7. These names for departments, or company-parts, have the same meaning:

department	institute	(none): R&D, QA/QC, "sales"	group	division	_____ affairs (e.g. "Regulatory Affairs")	section
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